

Chapter 5

Why We Impulse Shop

Two years ago, Travis and I (Jen) bought a fixer-upper. We spent two years renovating our home, and those years were some of the most stressful ones of my life. We slept in the living room for six weeks, the four of us shared one bathroom for six months, and we spent two months without a kitchen. On top of all that, we had a second baby, Jill and I published 175 episodes of *Frugal Friends*, and I wrote half of this book. I don't know if it was postpartum hormones or the handyman who lived in my guest room for several months, but my life felt out of my control. To compensate for the chaos at home, I'd make pit-stops at Starbucks for a little treat latte or take my sons to walk around the grocery store. Thankfully, we'd budgeted for some extra "stress spending" during the renovation. But when it was over and I didn't have the excuse (or the funds) to support my new coping mechanisms, I was a little embarrassed at how hard it was to return my spending to normal.

Change is hard, whether you're changing a habit you've had for years or a few weeks. It's exponentially harder when it's something you've been doing your whole life.

Whenever you stop or change direction, there's going to be friction. A lot of us hate the friction, but without it, it would be impossible to make the shift. Friction is the uncomfortable brush with reality that allows us to go in a different direction. A lot of people give up on doing new things because they forget that. We want our actions to change at the same pace our mind